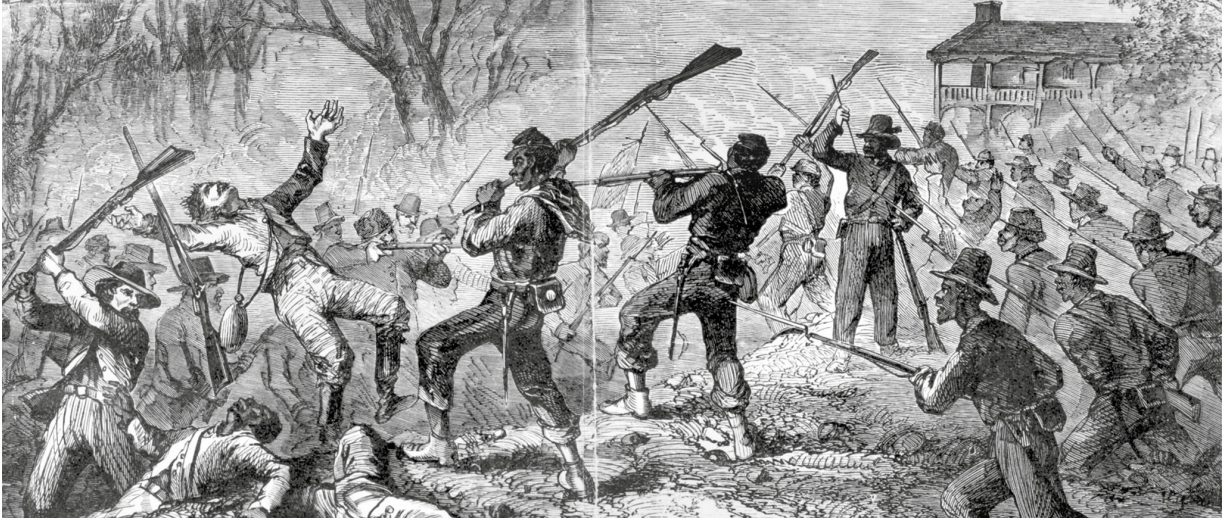




Battle of Milliken's Bend

On June 7, 1863 a small Union force was attacked by 1,500 Texans at Milliken's Bend, Louisiana. The bravery of the Black Americans fighting that day earned them new respect, paving the way for Black enlistment.

“... arming the negro ... is the heaviest blow yet given the Confederacy.”

UNION GENERAL-IN-CHIEF ULYSSES S. GRANT TO PRESIDENT LINCOLN,
AUGUST 23, 1863

Official discrimination

It took demonstrated bravery on the battlefield for such racial stereotypes and prejudice to subside. By the war's end, most white Federal troops still viewed their Black comrades somewhat askance, but few questioned their value and devotion to the Union cause. However, Black troops still had to deal with bureaucratized discrimination.

At first, Black privates received \$12 a month, the same as white soldiers, but in June 1863, the War Department announced that henceforth they would only receive \$10, and be required to pay \$3 of that toward a clothing allowance. In June 1864, this cruel